Bantuas M. Lucman

Bantuas "Banjo" M. Lucman is a Filipino lawyer, academic, and public servant who serves as the Bangsamoro Attorney General. He was officially appointed to the position on April 14, 2025, by BARMM Chief Minister Abdulraof Macacua.

As the head of the Bangsamoro Attorney General's Office (BAGO), Lucman acts as the chief legal counsel of the Bangsamoro Government and the principal legal advisor to the Chief Minister. With over two decades of experience in litigation and corporate law, his tenure is defined by efforts to harmonize Philippine civil law, indigenous customary traditions, and Shari'ah jurisprudence into a cohesive regional framework.

Bantuas M. Lucman	
File:Placeholder image.jpg Attorney General of the Bangsamoro	
Office Details	
Office	Bangsamoro Attorney General
Term Start	April 14, 2025
Chief Minister	Abdulraof Macacua
Predecessor	Sha Elijah B. Dumama-Alba
Personal Profile	
Birth Name	Bantuas M. Lucman
Nickname	Banjo
Birth Place	Lanao del Sur, Philippines
Nationality	Filipino
Alma Mater	University of the East (Law)
Profession	Attorney, Law Professor
Known For	Chief Legal Counsel of BARMM; Tri-Justice Advocate

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Early Life and Cultural Background

Lucman was born and raised in the province of Lanao del Sur, a region deeply rooted in Meranau culture and complex socio-political history. He is recognized by his local community as a prominent *Moriatao Diwan* (descendant of noble ancestry), with close ancestral ties to the municipality of Bayang.

Growing up in the Meranau heartland, Lucman was exposed early to the intersections of traditional customary laws, Islamic principles, and the formal Philippine legal system. This unique cultural environment profoundly shaped his approach to public administration, instilling a lifelong focus on defending marginalized and underserved communities.

Education and Legal Career

Lucman pursued his legal education at the **University of the East** (UE) College of Law. After admission to the Philippine Bar, he embarked on a private legal practice spanning more than twenty years, establishing himself as a formidable litigator.

Private Practice

Throughout his career in the private sector, Lucman managed a diverse legal portfolio encompassing civil, criminal, commercial, maritime, and labor law. He served as a leading partner in notable firms, including Balbin | Lucman | Del Rosario & Partners, which later evolved into **Lucman Calde Law Partners**. In the courtroom, he earned a reputation for combining sharp corporate strategy with a dedicated pro-bono practice focused on individuals who lacked access to the justice system.

Academia

In addition to active courtroom litigation, Lucman entered academia as a law professor at the University of the East. For several years, he taught future attorneys the complexities of the Law on Partnership and Corporation, emphasizing the role of corporate ethics and social responsibility in modern legal practice.

Institutional Contributions

Upon taking the helm of BAGO in April 2025, Lucman initiated several structural and policy reforms aimed at modernizing the BARMM legal apparatus while respecting its unique autonomy.

The Tri-Justice Framework

Lucman is a leading proponent of an inclusive "Tri-Justice Framework" for the region. He has consistently advocated that a truly functional regional legal system must seamlessly balance state law, customary law, and Islamic jurisprudence by actively engaging both local justice dispensers and grassroots communities.

National-Regional Inter-Agency Alignment

In mid-2025, Lucman spearheaded crucial bilateral dialogues with the national government's chief lawyer, Solicitor General Darlene Marie B. Berberabe. This historic coordination aligned the mandates of BAGO and the Office of the Solicitor General (OSG), ensuring that BARMM's unique autonomous legal interests are accurately represented in national court proceedings without jurisdictional friction.

Shari'ah and Civil Law Integration

To better understand dual-legal governance, Lucman personally led a high-level BAGO delegation to Malaysia to study its parallel civil and Shari'ah court mechanisms. Under his leadership, BAGO began adapting these international strategies—focusing on digital case-tracking systems, institutionalized mediation, and legally enforceable fatwas—to build a culturally responsive legal framework in the Bangsamoro.

Unification of Regional Legal Officers

Lucman serves as the chairperson of the Legal Officers Network (LLN) Board. In this capacity, he has worked to unify and standardize the legal strategies across all ministries, agencies, and offices within the Bangsamoro government, ensuring a cohesive institutional defense of the public good.

Cultural and Social Significance

Beyond administrative duties, Lucman's leadership is characterized by a strong humanitarian focus. He expanded BAGO's reach by launching **Community Legal Service** programs in remote municipalities like Madamba, Lanao del Sur. These programs translate and demystify complex state legislation (such as anti-violence laws) for rural populations while explicitly validating women's rights under Islamic traditions.

Furthermore, his office established the BAGO Gender and Development Focal Point System (GFPS). This initiative drives localized social welfare actions, such as distributing essential healthcare and maternity starter kits to expectant mothers in impoverished communities, reflecting his core philosophy that a strong regional state must be built on a foundation of community care.

See Also

- Bangsamoro
- Bangsamoro Attorney General's Office
- Bangsamoro Parliament

References

<references />

- Bangsamoro Attorney General's Office (BAGO) Official Website (https://bangsamoro.gov.ph)
- Official Gazettes and Press Releases of the Bangsamoro Government (April 2025 – Present)

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